



I was thinking about making a meal planning PWA application for the web and mobile. What is the core functionality and must have features and could you make a simple and clean product requirements document for such an app

A meal planning PWA app helps users organize weekly meals, generate shopping lists, and track preferences via a web-based interface that installs like a native app on mobile or desktop. Core functionality revolves around recipe management, drag-and-drop calendars, and automated lists, with must-haves like personalization, offline access, and sharing.^{[1] [2] [3]}

Product Overview

MealPlan PWA is a progressive web app for simple, effective meal planning. It targets busy professionals and families, enabling quick weekly plans from recipes, auto-generated grocery lists, and dietary customization. As a PWA, it offers offline use, home-screen installation, and responsive design across devices.^{[2] [4] [5]}

Target Users

- Tech-savvy individuals (e.g., developers) needing fast, customizable planning.
- Families sharing plans and lists.
- Users with dietary needs like vegetarian, keto, or allergies.^{[6] [7] [1]}

Core Functionality

- Browse/add recipes with import from URLs or manual entry.
- Drag-and-drop calendar for daily/weekly/monthly plans.
- Auto-generate editable shopping lists from selected meals.
- Personalization via preferences, macros, and swaps.^{[3] [5] [2]}

Must-Have Features

Feature	Description	Priority
Recipe Database	Searchable collection; import/clip from web; nutrition info ^{[2] [3] [5]} .	High
Meal Calendar	Drag-drop scheduling; copy/clear plans; daily/weekly views ^{[2] [8]} .	High
Grocery Lists	Auto-generate/categorize; checkboxes; export/print ^{[1] [6] [3]} .	High

Feature	Description	Priority
User Profiles	Dietary prefs, allergies, goals; favorites/swaps ^[6] ^[9] ^[5] .	High
Offline Mode	PWA caching for plans/lists; sync on reconnect ^[2] ^[4] .	High
Sharing	Family sync; public links for plans/lists ^[2] ^[6] .	Medium
Notifications	Reminders for prep/shopping ^[5] .	Medium
Search/Filter	By tags, cuisine, time, macros ^[10] ^[11] .	Medium

Technical Requirements

- Framework: React/Vue/Svelte for PWA (service worker, manifest).
- Storage: IndexedDB/localStorage for offline; optional Firebase/Supabase for sync/sharing.
- Responsive UI: Mobile-first, dark mode.
- No backend initially; expand to user auth later.^[4] ^[2]

Future Enhancements

AI meal suggestions, grocery integrations, macro tracking.^[12] ^[7]

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1. <https://ollie.ai/2025/10/29/best-meal-planning-apps-2025/>
2. <https://github.com/julianpoy/recipesage>
3. <https://www.zazz.io/blog/top-8-features-of-highly-profiting-meal-planning-apps>
4. https://www.reddit.com/r/sveltejs/comments/pbpqt7/mobile_meal_planner_app_built_with_svelte/
5. <https://www.octalsoftware.com/blog/meal-planner-app-development>
6. <https://www.devopsschool.com/blog/top-10-meal-planning-apps-features-pros-cons-comparison/>
7. <https://fitia.app/learn/article/best-meal-planning-apps-2026/>
8. <https://www.mealplanner.app/features>
9. <https://8fit.com/nutrition/using-a-meal-planning-app-benefits-and-features/>
10. <https://dev.to/thormeier/yummyplan-an-app-to-plan-meals-for-an-entire-week-5f41>
11. https://www.reddit.com/r/MealPlanYourMacros/comments/1idwt1s/building_a_meal_plan_app_any_request_s/
12. <https://www.valtorian.com/blog/the-best-meal-planner-in-2026>
13. <https://ollie.ai/2025/10/21/best-meal-planning-apps-in-2025/>
14. https://www.reddit.com/r/MealPlanYourMacros/comments/1et52p7/what_features_would_you_find_essential_in_a_top/
15. <https://www.scratchtobasics.com/best-meal-planning-apps/>
16. <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=meal.planner>

17. <https://thetimefairy.co.uk/4-really-useful-free-meal-planner-apps/>

18. <https://www.appdevelopmentpros.com/blog/8-key-features-of-profitable-meal-planning-apps/>